PS50008A Research Methods & Experimental Design

Term 2 Spring 2026 | Goldsmiths Psychology

Gordon Wright

27 May 2026

Welcome

Welcome to PS50008A Research Methods & Experimental Design. This module introduces the fundamental principles of psychological research, experimental design, and statistical analysis.

> ! First Week
>
> NO LECTURE IN WEEK 11 - Employability session with the rest of the undergrad cohort!
>
> Your first Research Methods session is **Thursday of Week 11** in the labs. Read the preview reading before attending.

Module Overview

Module Code	PS50008A
Credits	30 (Level 3 / Foundation)
Term	2 (January - March 2026)
Module Lead	Gordon Wright
Contact	g.wright@gold.ac.uk

What You'll Learn

This module teaches you to think like a researcher:

- **Design** experiments that can actually answer your questions
- **Analyse** data using both conceptual understanding and practical R skills
- **Interpret** results appropriately (including knowing what you *can't* claim)
- **Report** findings in professional APA format
- **Collaborate** on a real research project

DataLab

In Week 11, you'll participate in **DataLab**—a series of cognitive tasks and group activities that generate the dataset you'll analyse throughout the term. This means you'll learn statistics using *your own data*, not abstract examples.

Assessments

There are four assessments, all in Term 2:

Assessment	Weight	Due
Research Plan	20%	Fri 27 Feb (Week 16)
MCQ Exam	20%	Wed 11 Mar (Week 18)
EDS Assignment	20%	Fri 20 Mar (Week 19)
Research Report	40%	1 May 2026

See the Assessments page for full details.

Weekly Structure

Each week typically includes:

Component	Description
Lecture	Core concepts and theory (recorded)
Lecture Reading	Textbook content for the week
Lab	Hands-on practical work with R
Lab Activity	Interactive WebR exercises
Self-Assessment	Weekly consolidation exercises

Teaching Team

Role	Name	Contact
Module Lead	Dr Gordon Wright	g.wright@gold.ac.uk
Lab Instructor	Dr Bence Palfi	

Getting Started

1. Read the Syllabus for full module information
2. Check the Schedule for dates and topics

3. Review the Assessments to understand what’s expected
4. Prepare for Week 11 by reading the module intro

Quick Links

This Week

- Week 11: DataLab

Key Pages

- Schedule
- Assessments
- Resources